

A L^AT_EX Template for Transportation Research Board Annual Meeting Papers

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1 ABSTRACT

2 For the 2027 Transportation Research Board (TRB) Annual Meeting, TRB has updated their re-
3 quirements for the submission process. This template offers a pragmatic starting point for authors
4 using LaTeX (and related literate programming tools) while matching TRB conventions. Note that
5 the Abstract now must be formatted as a structured abstract per TRB guidance and it must be less
6 than 300 words. The content below summarizes what each section of the structured abstract should
7 include based on TRB's Instructions For Authors.

8
9 **Objectives:** In 2–3 sentences, define the specific transportation problem and context. State the
10 objective of this paper and the specific need being addressed. Do not include broad background or
11 literature review content.

12
13 **Methods:** In 3–4 sentences, describe the study design and technical rigor. Identify data type(s),
14 source(s), and scope (e.g., sample size, time frame, and geography). Summarize the analytical
15 approach used to evaluate the objective.

16
17 **Findings:** In 2–3 sentences, report the most important results. Indicate whether results are sig-
18 nificant based on statistical testing, sensitivity analysis, validation, and/or rigorous qualitative
19 assessment.

20
21 **Novelty:** In 1–2 sentences, clearly state the novel transportation contribution of this work.

22
23 **Practical Applications:** In 1–2 sentences, explain how findings inform transportation practice
24 and/or policy, including specific implementation considerations or operational contexts.

1 INTRODUCTION

2 The Transportation Research Board (TRB) currently requires submissions of full papers to be
3 considered for presentation at the TRB Annual Meeting (Transportation Research Board 2025).
4 The Instructions For Authors website (<https://trb.secure-platform.com/a/page/TRBPaperReview>)
5 outlines specific requirements for submissions. Initial submissions are PDFs, while accepted papers
6 for the *Transportation Research Record* may require Microsoft Office formats. Manuscripts must
7 be line-numbered; captions are bold with TRB-specific punctuation; in-text citations now use
8 author–date format, and the reference list is alphabetical rather than numbered. See the author
9 information online at <https://trb.secure-platform.com/a/page/TRBPaperReview>.

10 We assume basic familiarity with $\text{\LaTeX}$ and `bibtex`. As literate programming becomes
11 more common, the template may evolve to support additional workflows.

12 History

13 Pritchard (2025) released the original template in 2009 and updated it in 2011. Macfarlane (2025)
14 extended it in 2012 (Sweave integration and auto counts). Wang (2025) automated total word
15 count calculation and improved formatting in 2015, added GitHub releases in 2016, and provided
16 $\text{\TeX}$ -only variants in 2017 (https://github.com/chiehrosswang/TRB_LaTeX_tex) and an RNW
17 version (https://github.com/chiehrosswang/TRB_LaTeX_rnw). The 2019 and 2025 updates
18 focused on the $\text{\TeX}$ -only version: the 2019 update improved Overleaf compatibility, while the 2025
19 update enhanced word-counting and authorship blocks.

20 In May 2026, Wang (2025) made several updates to reflect the modifications TRB intro-
21 ducted to the 2027 Annual Meeting submission process, including but not limited to, simplifying the
22 calculation of submission length, requiring a structured abstract, and requiring a standard citation
23 style (i.e., Chicago author–date).

24 FEATURES

25 This template targets quick and TRB-compliant manuscript assembly (Transportation Research
26 Board 2025).

27 Title Page

28 The class provides a custom `\maketitle` that prints authors (via `\TRBauthor`), a word count
29 (with tables counted as 250 words each by default), and the submission date. Word counting uses
30 `texcount` via shell escape; compile with `--shell-escape` (see the BUILD section).

31 Page Layout

32 Margins are 1 in. The running header shows authors (set with `\AuthorHeaders`) at the left and
33 the page number at the right. Headings and spacing follow TRB conventions.

34 Line Numbers

35 Line numbering uses the `lineno` package and resets each page. Blank lines are not numbered. The
36 `numbered` class option enables line numbers.

37 MORE FEATURES

38 Captions

39 Figure 1 shows a Gumbel distribution as an example. Figure captions use sentence case. Table
40 captions use Title Case and function as a short title. Table 1 summarizes the template history. Both

1 Figure and Table captions are bold.

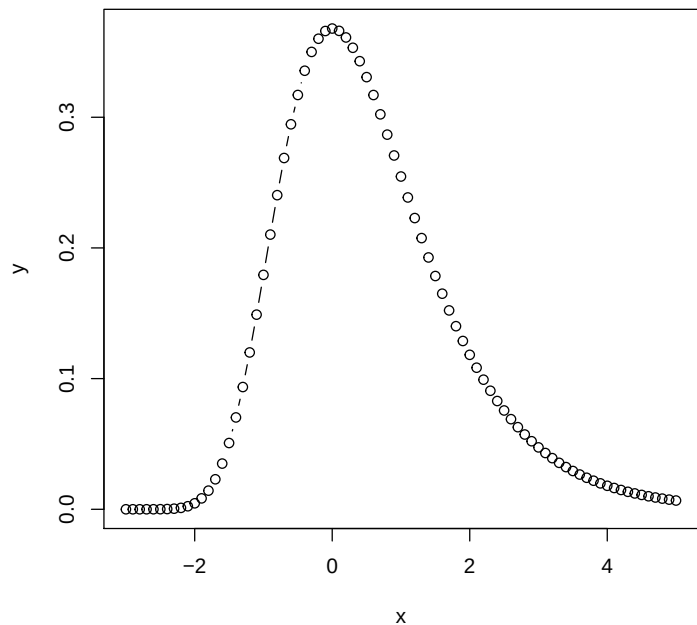


FIGURE 1 Example figure illustrating the caption style and counting on the title page.

TABLE 1 A History of this Template

Version	Date	Author	Contributions
1.0	Sep 2009	Pritchard	Initial work
1.1	Mar 2011	Pritchard	Caption fixes
2.0	Mar 2012	Macfarlane	Automation, documentation
2.1	Jul 2015	Wang	More automation and formatting
2.1.1	Jan 2016	Wang	Minor modifications; GitHub
2.1.1 Lite	Jun 2017	Wang	T _E X-only template
3.1	Jun 2017	Wang	Added <code>trbunofficial.cls</code>
3.1 Lite	Jun 2017	Wang	Added <code>trbunofficial.cls</code>
4.0 Lite	Jul 2019	Wang	Word-count updates for Overleaf
5.0 Lite	Aug 2025	Wang	Word-count improvements*
6.0 Lite	Jun 2026	Wang	Replaced word count with page count; updated citation style

* Total counts include: Title, front matter, body texts, headers, captions, references. Total word counts do not include text in tables (each table is automatically counted as 250 words).

1 Bibliography

2 Use `trb.bst`. The commands `\cite{}` and `\citet{}` produce author–date citations. References
3 appear in alphabetical order by first author. Here is an example using `\cite[]{} (Meyer and`
4 `Miller 2001, 21-25)` and another example `Garrow et al. (2009)` using `\citet{}`.

5 Other examples include Bierlaire (2003, 2008); Garrow et al. (2009); Koppelman and
6 Garrow (2005) and grouped citations (Bierlaire 2003; Garrow et al. 2009; Koppelman and
7 Garrow 2005).

8 Equations

9 Equations are left aligned with no extra indentation. Below is the Intelligent Driver Model (from
10 https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Intelligent_driver_model).

$$11 \quad \dot{x}_\alpha = \frac{dx_\alpha}{dt} = v_\alpha, \quad (1)$$

$$12 \quad \dot{v}_\alpha = \frac{dv_\alpha}{dt} = a \left(1 - \left(\frac{v_\alpha}{v_0} \right)^\delta - \left(\frac{s^*(v_\alpha, \Delta v_\alpha)}{s_\alpha} \right)^2 \right), \quad (2)$$

$$13 \quad s^*(v_\alpha, \Delta v_\alpha) = s_0 + v_\alpha T + \frac{v_\alpha \Delta v_\alpha}{2\sqrt{ab}}. \quad (3)$$

14 Referencing Sections by Custom Names

15 Because this template does not use section numbering, referencing sections directly can be difficult.
16 To address this, you can create hyperlinks to labeled sections with your own display text using the
17 `\customref` command: `\customref{Displayed Text}{label}`.

18 For example, if you have defined `\label{sec:intro}` for the Introduction section, you can
19 write `\customref{INTRODUCTION section}{sec:intro}` to produce a hyperlink that appears
20 as INTRODUCTION section.

21 CONCLUSION AND BUILD

22 This is a placeholder for conclusions. Use the following command to build with automatic page
23 counting:

24 `latexmk trb_template.tex -pdf -pvc`

25 ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

26 We thank Aleksandar Trifunovic (<https://github.com/akstrfn>) for putting together the initial
27 `trbunofficial` class that advanced this work.

28 AUTHOR CONTRIBUTIONS

29 The authors confirm contribution to the paper as follows: study conception and design: X. Author,
30 Y. Author; data collection: Y. Author; analysis and interpretation of results: X. Author, Y. Author,
31 Z. Author; draft manuscript preparation: Y. Author, Z. Author. All authors reviewed the results
32 and approved the final version of the manuscript.

33 DECLARATION OF CONFLICTING INTERESTS

34 X. Author is a member of Transportation Research Record’s Editorial Board. All other authors
35 declare no potential conflicts of interest with respect to the research, authorship, and publication of

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